Weekly Meal Skeleton Planner

Flexible themes, not rigid recipes — plan in five gentle minutes

HOW THE SKELETON WORKS

1. **Pick a theme per night,** not a recipe. "Pasta night" can be forty different meals.
2. **Anchor recipes you already make well** to their themes. Two favorites per theme is plenty.
3. **Budget one cooking night and one leftovers night** — the skeleton absorbs the chaos.
4. **Leave one empty night** for pizza-or-pantry night. Zero guilt is part of the plan.
5. **Shop from the themes,** not the dinners: cheese + pasta + jar sauce + protein covers a pasta night.

SUGGESTED ROTATIONS — STEAL THESE

THEME	EASY PICKS
Monday · **Pasta**	Red sauce + white beans; olive oil + garlic + parmesan; tuna + lemon + capers
Tuesday · **Stir-fry / skillet**	Frozen veg bag + rice + whatever protein + 2 min sauce
Wednesday · **Soup or stew**	Canned beans + broth + grain + veg; lentils, always lentils
Thursday · **Tacos / wraps**	Rotisserie chicken + tortillas; black beans + avocado + salsa
Friday · **Oven sheet-pan**	Veg + protein + oil + seasoning, one pan, done in 30 min
Saturday · **Treat or eat-out**	Function is fun, not fuel
Sunday · **Cook once, eat twice**	Braise, roast, or double a soup — lunches are now handled

THIS WEEK (PRINT A COPY, GRAB A PENCIL)

NIGHT	THEME	MEAL IDEA	NOTES / WHO'S COOKING / LEFTOVERS PITFALL
Mon			
Tue			
Wed			
Thu			
Fri			
Sat			
Sun			

PANTRY RESCUE KIT (ALWAYS KEEP THESE)

- 2 cans beans (any)
- 1 lb pasta
- 1 jar red sauce
- Bag of frozen veg
- Broth: 2 cans or bouillon
- 2 eggs
- Rice or quinoa
- Flour + cornmeal
- Garlic + onion
- Tinned fish
- Tortillas
- Cheddar or parmesan

ADHD-friendly yips: put the planner on the fridge, not a to-do app. A dinner you *did* plan at 5 pm beats a "perfect" plan you never looked at. Pasta counts as cooking. Frozen veg counts as fresh-enough.